

## Nursena Ataseven

n.ataseven@rug.nl

### Education

**University of Groningen** | Groningen, the Netherlands Sep 2023 – present

*PhD Candidate*, Advisors: Prof. Dr. Elkan G. Akyürek & Dr. Wouter Kruijne

*PhD Trainee at the Research School of Behavioural and Cognitive Neurosciences (BCN)*

**Leibniz Research Institute for Working Environment and** Sep 2024 – Sep 2025

**Human Factors** | Dortmund, Germany

*Visiting Researcher*, Advisor: Dr. Daniel Schneider

**Sabancı University** | Istanbul, Turkey Sep 2020 – June 2023

*MSc Cognitive Psychology*, Advisor: Dr. Eren Günseli

**Masaryk University** | Brno, Czechia Feb 2019 – July 2019

*Erasmus Exchange Student, BA Psychology*

**MEF University** | Istanbul, Turkey Oct 2016 – June 2020

*BA Psychology*

### Publications (and Preprints)

**Ataseven, N.**, Özdemir, Ş., Akyürek, E. G., Schneider, D., & Kruijne, W. (2026, preprint). Mentally transformed representations in memory are linked to their originals. *bioRxiv*.

<https://doi.org/10.64898/2026.09.10.750562>

**Ataseven, N.**, Özdemir, Ş., Kruijne, W., Schneider, D., & Akyürek, E. G. (2026, preprint). Diffuse predictions stabilize and reshape the neural code during working memory encoding. *bioRxiv*.

<https://doi.org/10.64898/2026.02.23.707359>

**Ataseven, N.**, Algin, E., Yücel, D., Güler, B., Todorova, L., Fukuda, K., & Günseli, E. (2026). Memory reactivation levels remain unaffected by anticipated interference. *Journal of Cognitive Neuroscience*, 1–12. <https://doi.org/10.1162/jocn.a.2625>

Yılmaz, Y., **Ataseven, N.**, Kruijne, W., Akyürek, E., & Günseli, E. (2026). Passive but accessible: Studied information is not actively stored in working memory, yet attended regardless of anticipated load. *Journal of Cognitive Neuroscience*, 38(9), 1721–1734.

<https://doi.org/10.1162/jocn.a.2619>

**Ataseven, N.**, Ünver, N., & Günseli, E. (2023). How does divided attention hinder different stages of episodic memory retrieval?. *Current Research in Behavioral Sciences*, 100139.

<https://doi.org/10.1016/j.crbeha.2023.100139>

Yücel, D., **Ataseven, N.**, Todorova, L., Güler, B., Fukuda, K., & Günseli, E. (2023, preprint). Increased reliance on long-term memory when anticipating attentional guidance. *PsyArXiv*.

<https://doi.org/10.31234/osf.io/cs9qa>

Peker, M., Atar, H. Ö., & **Ataseven, N.** (2017). A review on interpersonal distance: Culture, gender, power, and directions for future research. *The British Psychological Society North East Branch Bulletin*, 6, 8-17.

### Ongoing Research

#### Writing Stage

Özdemir, Ş., **Ataseven, N.**, Kruijne, W., Akyürek, E. G., & Schneider, D. Key features of motor code formation in working memory.

#### Data Analysis Stage

**Ataseven, N.**, Brady, T. F., Kruijne, W., & Akyürek, E. G. Bidirectional relationship between statistical regularity learning and attention.

Özdemir, Ş., **Ataseven, N.**, Kruijne, W., Akyürek, E. G., & Schneider, D. Representational shift from sensory input to action plans in working memory.

**Nursena Ataseven**

n.ataseven@rug.nl

**Ataseven, N., Günseli, E., Kruijne, W., & Akyürek, E. G.** Anticipation of attentional demands modulates task performance through allocation of spatial attention.

**Ataseven, N., Kruijne, W., & Akyürek, E. G.** How does interference influence prioritised and unprioritised information?

#### **Invited Talks**

---

**University of Cambridge, the MRC Cognition and Brain Sciences Unit (To be presented, 2026)**

**Ataseven, N., Özdemir, Ş., Akyürek, E. G., Schneider, D., & Kruijne, W.** Neural representations underlying mental and physical transformation

**Bern University of Applied Sciences, AFC Lab Talk Series (Dr. Meike Ramon), 2026**

**Ataseven, N., Özdemir, Ş., Kruijne, W., Schneider, D., & Akyürek, E. G.** Mentally rotated representations are linked to their originals. Video recording:

[https://drive.google.com/file/d/16krOS3\\_InpM-JKMLYKa4v7DKGxok7C8L/view?usp=sharing](https://drive.google.com/file/d/16krOS3_InpM-JKMLYKa4v7DKGxok7C8L/view?usp=sharing)

**University of Würzburg, the Research Seminar, 2024**

**Ataseven, N., Özdemir, Ş., Kruijne, W., Schneider, D., & Akyürek, E. G.** Prior information shapes representations in visual working memory.

#### **Conference Presentations**

---

##### *Talks*

**Annual Working Memory Symposium, 2026 (Blitz)**

**Ataseven, N., Özdemir, Ş., Kruijne, W., Schneider, D., & Akyürek, E. G.** Mental rotation products are bound to their initially encoded originals: maintained together and dropped together.

**NVP Winter Conference organized by Dutch Society for Brain and Cognition, 2025**

**Symposium: Computational and neural mechanisms of prediction**

**Ataseven, N., Özdemir, Ş., Kruijne, W., Schneider, D., & Akyürek, E. G.** Prior information about upcoming stimulus influences stimulus representation at encoding

**Annual Working Memory Symposium, 2025 (Blitz)**

**Ataseven, N., Özdemir, Ş., Kruijne, W., Schneider, D., & Akyürek, E. G.** Revealing the effect of prior information on neural representations in WM.

**Annual Working Memory Symposium, 2024 (Blitz)**

**Ataseven, N., Günseli, E., Kruijne, W., & Akyürek, E.** Attentional allocation to target memories when anticipating distractors.

**Annual Working Memory Symposium, 2023**

**Ataseven, N., Todorova, L., Yücel, D., Güler, B., Fukuda, K., & Günseli, E.** The effect of anticipated interference, memory load, and long-term memory availability on working memory reactivation.

**Annual Working Memory Symposium, 2022**

**Ataseven, N., Todorova, L., Yücel, D., Güler, B., Fukuda, K., & Günseli, E.** Information available in long-term memory is reactivated in working memory regardless of anticipated perceptual interference.

##### *Posters*

**Cognitive Neuroscience Society Conference, 2026**

## **Nursena Ataseven**

n.ataseven@rug.nl

**Ataseven, N., Özdemir, Ş., Kruijne, W., Schneider, D., & Akyürek, E. G.** Diffuse predictions reshape WM representations at encoding

### **Vision Sciences Society, 2025**

**Ataseven N., Özdemir Ş., Schneider D., Kruijne W., & Akyurek E. G.** Revealing the effect of regularities on representations in visual working memory. <https://doi.org/10.1167/jov.25.9.2625>

### **NVP Winter Conference organized by Dutch Society for Brain and Cognition, 2023**

**Ataseven, N., Kruijne W., & Akyürek E. G.** The role of activity-silent working memory in protection against distraction.

### **European Society for Cognitive Psychology, 2023**

**Ataseven, N., Todorova, L., Yücel, D., Güler, B, Fukuda, K., & Günseli, E.** Working memory takes over long-term memory when anticipating perceptual interference.

## **Professional Service**

---

**Symposium Chair**, “Computational and Neural Mechanisms of Prediction” at the NVP Winter Conference, 2023.

Speakers: Nursena Ataseven, Dr. Eelke Spaak, Dr. Darinka Trübutschek, Prof. Floris de Lange.

**Organizer**, Experimental Psychology Meetings 2025-2026, University of Groningen

**Peer Reviewer**, Memory & Cognition, Acta Psychologica Sinica

## **Teaching Experience**

---

**Workshop Instructor**, CogIST

August 2026

*Memory, Prediction, and Imagination: How Does the Mind Use the Past to Predict the Future?*

- Delivered a three-week workshop (2 hours per week).

**Lecturer**, University of Groningen

Sep 2023 - present

- Research Practicum

- Responsibilities:

- Guided and evaluated students as they wrote their first scientific paper.

- Academic Skills

- Gave a year-round course focused on development of academic skills.

- Guided and evaluated students through oral presentations, essay writing, and a literature review.

- Bachelor Thesis

- Supervised a group of Bachelor’s students throughout the thesis-writing process.

- Statistics III

- Responsibilities:

- Held office hours and supported students with statistical analysis assignments.

- Graded students’ assignments and provided feedback.

**Teaching Assistant**, Sabancı University

Sep 2020 – Sep 2023

- PSY304: Research Methods and Statistics for Psychology II

- PSY316: Attention

**Nursena Ataseven**

n.ataseven@rug.nl

---

### Scholarships

|                                                                                               |                      |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------|
| Full scholarship granted by Scientific and Technological Research Council of Turkey (TUBITAK) | Sep 2020 – Jan 2023  |
| BIDEB 2232 International Fellowship for Outstanding Researchers Programme                     |                      |
| Full tuition scholarship granted by Sabancı University                                        | Sep 2016 – June 2020 |
| Full tuition scholarship granted by MEF University                                            | Sep 2016 – June 2020 |

---

### Awards

Yale Wu Tsai Institute Travel Award for attending CNS 2026 (500\$)  
<https://www.cogneurosociety.org/past-award-winners/>

---

### Skills

**Programming:** MATLAB, R, Python  
**Toolboxes:** Psychtoolbox, EEGLAB, ERPLAB, Fieldtrip  
**Data acquisition:** EEG

---

### References

**Prof. Dr. Elkan Akyürek**

*PhD Supervisor*

University of Groningen

[e.g.akyurek@rug.nl](mailto:e.g.akyurek@rug.nl)

**Dr. Wouter Kruijne**

*PhD Supervisor*

University of Groningen

[w.kruijne@rug.nl](mailto:w.kruijne@rug.nl)

**PD. Dr. Daniel Schneider**

*Collaborator/Research Visit Supervisor*

Leibniz Research Centre for Working Environment and Human Factors

[schneiderd@ifado.de](mailto:schneiderd@ifado.de)

**Asst. Prof. Dr. Eren Günseli**

*MSc Supervisor*

Sabancı University

[eren.gunseli@sabanciuniv.edu](mailto:eren.gunseli@sabanciuniv.edu)